

Pre-Flight Privacy Checklist

Surveyor

Complete this checklist before every drone flight for aerial boundary surveys and survey operations.

Job Details

OPERATOR NAME

DATE OF SURVEY

SURVEY SITE / ADDRESS

CLIENT / ORGANISATION

LICENCE / RPA REG NO.

WEATHER CONDITIONS

1 — Consent & Authorisation

- ☐ **Written client / land owner consent obtained**
Engagement letter or consent form signed authorising aerial survey over the subject land.
- ☐ **Adjacent land owner consent or notification completed**
All parcels within the planned flight corridor identified; owners notified in writing.
- ☐ **Surveying licence / registration current and applicable to this survey type**
Confirm operator holds the appropriate cadastral, topographic or engineering survey authorisation.
- ☐ **Title search and cadastral boundary data reviewed**
Parcel boundaries confirmed from Titles Office data; discrepancies noted before flight.
- ☐ **Access agreement for ground control points (GCPs) confirmed**
Permission to physically access land for GCP placement obtained from land owners.
- ☐ **Privacy Act obligations explained to client**
Client understands aerial imagery may capture personal data of third parties on or near the site.

2 — No-Fly Zones & Airspace

- ☐ **Airspace checked via CASA tool (Airshare / OneSky)**
No restricted, prohibited or controlled airspace within planned flight area.
- ☐ **NOTAM reviewed for survey date and time**
No active NOTAMs affecting the site.
- ☐ **Proximity to aerodromes confirmed**
5.5 km radius from controlled aerodromes checked; CASA authorisation obtained if required.
- ☐ **Flight within visual line of sight (VLOS) or BVLOS approval held**
VLOS maintained or BVLOS approval from CASA confirmed in writing for large survey areas.
- ☐ **Operating height at or below 120 m AGL (or approved altitude)**
Maximum planned altitude confirmed; survey grid height set to satisfy GSD requirements.
- ☐ **Flight plan and survey grid reviewed for proximity to sensitive infrastructure**
Power lines, communication towers, rail corridors and pipelines identified on flight plan.

3 — Privacy Risk Assessment

- ☐ **Residential dwellings within or adjacent to the survey area identified**
Windows, courtyards, gardens and pools mapped; camera angle and altitude adjusted accordingly.
- ☐ **Survey imagery scope limited to the subject parcel and immediate surrounds**
Overlap into neighbouring land minimised to the extent required for survey accuracy.
- ☐ **People likely to be present on or near the site during the survey considered**
Site access controlled where possible; bystanders and occupants notified of flight timing.
- ☐ **Signage or notification to occupants and neighbours arranged**
Letter drop or signage erected where practical to notify affected parties of aerial survey.
- ☐ **Survey imagery does not capture private spaces beyond what is technically necessary**
Ground sampling distance (GSD) and flight altitude set to minimise unnecessary detail of private areas.

4 — Data Collection Limits

- ☐ **Survey extent limited to the agreed project scope**
Flight plan boundary matches the survey brief; no speculative data collection outside the parcel.
- ☐ **Imagery resolution appropriate to survey purpose — not excessive**
GSD set to minimum required for the deliverable; unnecessarily high resolution of private areas avoided.
- ☐ **Oblique or facade imagery of dwellings minimised**
Nadir (straight-down) imagery preferred; oblique passes over occupied dwellings avoided where possible.
- ☐ **Audio recording disabled**
Onboard microphone off for the duration of the survey flight.
- ☐ **Thermal or multispectral sensors used only where specified in the brief**
Enhanced sensing documented in the engagement; scope limited to agreed survey deliverables.

5 — Data Handling & Storage

- ☐ **SD card / storage media is blank before the survey flight**
No residual imagery or data from previous surveys on recording media.
- ☐ **Raw imagery transferred to encrypted survey storage within 24 hours**
AES-256 encrypted drive or approved survey platform with access controls.
- ☐ **Survey data access restricted to authorised project personnel only**
Access log maintained; sharing with subconsultants or other parties requires written consent.
- ☐ **Retention period and deletion schedule agreed with client**
Raw imagery and processed outputs held per contract; deletion schedule documented.
- ☐ **Survey deliverables do not include unnecessary personal data of third parties**
Orthophotos and point clouds reviewed before delivery; identifiable persons blurred if required.

6 — Equipment Pre-Flight Check

- ☐ **RPA registration / markings current and visible**
- ☐ **Battery charged at or above 80%; spare batteries checked**
- ☐ **Propellers inspected — no cracks or chips**
- ☐ **Return-to-home altitude set above tallest obstacle in survey area**
- ☐ **Camera / sensor calibrated; lens clean and undamaged**
- ☐ **Remote ID broadcasting confirmed (if required)**
- ☐ **Ground control points (GCPs) placed and coordinates recorded**
- ☐ **Survey mission plan uploaded and validated in flight software**

7 — Post-Flight Actions

- ☐ **Survey imagery reviewed for unintended personal data capture**
Flag imagery containing identifiable persons or private spaces beyond survey scope.
- ☐ **GCP coordinates and imagery checksums recorded in field notes**
All GCP IDs, coordinates and image counts logged for quality assurance.
- ☐ **Incident log updated if any privacy, safety or airspace issue arose**
Record complaints, near-misses or unplanned captures; notify client if required.
- ☐ **Client provided with copy of this completed checklist**
Signed copy retained by operator for minimum 7 years.

Operator Sign-Off

By signing below I confirm all checklist items have been reviewed and completed to the best of my knowledge.